



The **TOUGH** Tests

1

At Rs 2,04,000 crore over five years, will the legislation cost too much to implement?

No. It is distributed unevenly among various states. Seven states have to spend the most. Uttar Pradesh will have to spend Rs 54,000 crore over five years, Bihar Rs 39,000 crore, West Bengal Rs 16,000 crore, Jharkhand Rs 12,000 crore, Rajasthan Rs 9,000 crore, Maharashtra Rs 8,200 crore, and Madhya Pradesh almost Rs 7,700 crore. While the Centre has to spend 65 per cent of this, the state has to pay only 35 per cent. The percentage of recurring expenditure varies.

2

Can the shortage of 12.9 lakh teachers be met?

Yes. Of this 5.5 lakh teachers' posts are lying vacant. The additional number is designed to make up for the new teacher-student ratio of 1:30. Uttar Pradesh has the largest shortfall. There is a five-year window to ensure all teachers have the proper professional qualifications.

3

Will the 25 per cent quota in private schools for neighbourhood children of weaker or disadvantaged sections create grounds for litigation?

Yes, quite possibly, though schools will be reimbursed. A large section of private schools is charging less than what the Government will be paying them. The National Commission for Protection of Child Rights will identify 1,000 private schools to demonstrate how it can be done. The contract is between the school and the state. The norms will be worked out by the states in consultation with the Centre. But the reimbursement is restricted to tuition fees and there is no restriction on enhancement in fees charged to other children by private schools.

4

Isn't the RTE Act undemocratic in excluding children under six and those between 14 and 18?

It flows from the 86th Constitutional Amendment which made free and compulsory education for children between six and 14 a fundamental right. Anyway, across the globe, children are now meant to enter schools at the age of six. Yes, but there is no clarity on what happens to the child after Class VIII, only a vague hope that they will continue.

5

Will there be an overlap with the Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan?

No. That will be the vehicle for transferring resources to the states in the next two years. A committee has been set up to harmonise the norms of the Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan and the RTE Act. The NGOs which sprang up under the SSA will be encouraged to engage with the formal school set-up rather than persist with alternative schools.

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